6 Everyday use and help

FULL

25. Common questions

Quick version

Short answers to the questions people ask most. Each one says which menu keys to press.

Every day - Does the garden start by itself after a power cut or a restart? - Can I switch the computer off? - What happens when I close the laptop lid? - How do I know it is working? - Where are my web addresses? - On Windows: does the PC have to stay on? - Can I switch the garden off for a while?

Passwords and people - I forgot my website password. - I forgot my Ubuntu password. - Can a friend edit, or only look? - Who can see my garden? - Someone should not have access any more. - Where are my passwords and keys kept? - Should the website have its own Gmail? - I pasted a password or key somewhere by mistake.

When something is wrong - I made a mistake. How do I undo it? - My photos are missing. - The AI boxes do not answer. - My web name stopped working. - Is the disk filling up? - Where are the logs? - How do I ask for help without sharing passwords?

Changes and updates - How do I update the computer? - How do I update the garden's own programs? - How does the phone app update?

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Every day

Does the garden start by itself after a power cut or a restart?

Yes, once Ubuntu is running again (if the computer itself went off, press its power button). Docker then starts the garden by itself, even before anyone logs in, and the front door (Caddy) and the No-IP updater start too. One exception: if you stopped the garden with menu `3`, it stays stopped until you start it again.

Keys: menu `2` starts it. Menu `5` checks it. **More:** guide 19 (menu 2 and 3)

Can I switch the computer off?

Yes, nothing is lost. While it is off, nobody can open your garden, and no automatic backup happens (the first look after it is back on catches up). Switch it off the normal way: Ubuntu's top-right menu, then **Power Off**.

More: guide 13 (the automatic backup schedule)

What happens when I close the laptop lid?

Normally Ubuntu goes to sleep, and the garden stops. Guide 01, steps 24 and 25, makes the laptop stay awake with the lid closed. A closed laptop gets hot: leave the lid open a little.

More: guide 01 (Part G)

How do I know it is working?

Run the checklist. Each line says **PASS** (good), **WARN** (fix soon) or **FAIL** (fix first), with the fix written under it. The last line counts them: `0 fail` is what you want.

Keys: menu `5` (or `bash garden.sh check`). It is also saved in `CHECKLIST.txt`. **More:** guide 09

Where are my web addresses?

Menu `A` lists every address of your garden, and which ones need signing in. It also saves them in `MY-ADDRESSES.txt` in the garden folder.

Keys: menu `A` **More:** guide 23 (Part 15)

On Windows: does the PC have to stay on?

Yes. On Windows the garden runs inside Windows' own Ubuntu (WSL), so it stops when the PC is off or asleep. Set **Settings, System, Power, Sleep** to **Never**. After a restart, sign in to Windows: if you said yes to the "Jun's Garden keep running" task during the install, it starts the garden again; if not, use the Windows menu `2`.

More: guide 00b

Can I switch the garden off for a while?

Yes. Menu `M`, then `14`, then `1` (Everything OFF). It stops every program and the front door, and deletes nothing: your plants, photos, data, cache, backups and settings stay in their folders. Use it when you do not want to host the site for a while, or when the traffic is too much. Menu `M`, `14`, then `2` turns it all on again, even months later, and checks the website. While it is off, keep confirming your free No-IP name every 30 days.

Keys: menu `M`, then `14` **More:** guide 26 (The on / off switch)

Passwords and people

I forgot my website password.

On the login page, click **Forgot password? / First time?** and the website emails you a link. That only works when email is set up (menu `8`, then `3`). Or set a new password on the garden computer: menu `U`, then `5`. Nothing shows while you type; that is normal.

More: guide 07

I forgot my Ubuntu password.

Ubuntu cannot email you a new one. Start the computer in recovery mode, as Ubuntu's official page explains: https://wiki.ubuntu.com/RecoveryMode (hold `Shift`, or press `Esc`,

while it starts; choose **Advanced options**, then the line ending in **(recovery mode)**, then **Drop to root shell prompt**). Then type these one at a time, with your own user name instead of `jun`:

```
mount -o remount,rw /
passwd jun
reboot
```

More: guide 01 (your account), guide 22 (sudo and your password)

Can a friend edit, or only look?

Anyone can look at your garden once it is online; they need no account. To let a friend **edit**, use menu `U`, then `2`, and tell them their first password in person. A **guest** (menu `U`, then `3`) can only sign in on the sign-in page: no editing, no garden tools. Guests need the front door first (menu `M`, then `1`).

More: guide 07, guide 23 (Part 12)

Who can see my garden?

Before the front door, only the garden computer itself. Once it is online, everyone can see the website: the plant catalogue, the gallery, the blog. Only people on your user list can edit, and the garden tools (`/beds`) open only after signing in.

Keys: menu `U`, then `1` shows who can sign in. **More:** guide 07

Someone should not have access any more.

Menu `U`, then `4` removes every login that person has. Menu `U`, then `8` (LOCK DOWN) leaves only you: new passwords, and everyone is signed out.

More: guide 19 (Users and access)

Should the website have its own Gmail?

It is a good idea, and free: https://accounts.google.com/signup. Use it for the website's email (menu `M`, `3`), the Google Drive backups, the AI key, and to sign in to Tailscale, DuckDNS and No-IP with "Sign in with Google". Your personal inbox stays apart, and handing the website on one day means handing on one account. Turn on its 2-Step Verification. The garden's own sign-in stays your garden password: no outside account can open the garden.

One Gmail can also give each service its own address (`name+noip@gmail.com`), so you see who sends what: guide 00b, "Plan your website's name and email".

More: guide 00b

Where are my passwords and keys kept?

In one private file, `.env`, in the garden folder. Only you can read it. The menu never shows a password or key; it only says "set" or "not set". Never paste them into a chat, an email or an AI chat.

Keys: menu `K` for keys, menu `U`, then `5` for your password. **More:** guide 00 (rule 2)

I pasted a password or key somewhere by mistake.

Change it now. Your password: menu `U`, then `5`. A key: menu `K`, choose the key, then `1` to paste a new one; then delete the old key on that service's own website.

More: guide 09 (Safety problems)

When something is wrong

I made a mistake. How do I undo it?

Put a backup back: menu `7`, then pick one (the newest is at the top). Before it changes anything, it saves what is there now as a `before-restore` backup. Everything goes back to

the time of that backup. Changed your mind? Menu `7` again, and pick the `before-restore` one.

Keys: menu `7` **More:** guide 13

My photos are missing.

The photos are a separate download: `junsgarden-photos-addon.zip`. Leave it zipped in your Home, Downloads or Desktop folder, then choose menu `6`, then `11`. Photos you already have are kept. Photos you added yourself and then lost come back with a backup (menu `7`).

Keys: menu `6`, then `11` **More:** guide 13

The AI boxes do not answer.

Test your key: menu `K`, then `1` (Gemini), then `2` (Test). If it says the key is wrong, choose `1` and paste it again. If it says the free limit is used up, it resets tomorrow. A free OpenRouter key is a backup for busy times: menu `K`, then `2`, then `1`.

More: guide 16

My web name stopped working.

A free No-IP name must be confirmed every 30 days: No-IP emails you a link, click **Confirm** (look in spam too). Then run the checklist (menu `5`): it shows whether the No-IP updater is running and whether the name points at your home. If the updater is not running: menu `K`, then `N`.

More: guide 09 (The internet side), guide 04

Is the disk filling up?

The checklist's last check says "Disk is ...% full": PASS under 85%, FAIL from 85%. Automatic backups are thinned by themselves (today's newest 3, then one a day for a week). Backups you make yourself are never deleted for you, and each one is about 800 MB. To free space, copy your old ones to a USB stick, delete them from `backups/`, then use the clean-up: menu

`M`, `14`, then `5`. It removes only Docker's leftovers (old versions of the garden's programs, older than 7 days) and asks first.

Keys: menu `5`, and menu `M`, then `14` **More:** guide 13, guide 09, guide 26

Where are the logs?

The garden programs' recent messages: menu `M`, then `6`. The install and the front door save everything they show in the `logs/` folder (`logs/install-progress.txt` shows where an install stopped). The nightly backup writes to `backups/backup.log`.

Keys: menu `M`, then `6` **More:** guide 09 (Look at the logs)

How do I ask for help without sharing passwords?

Menu `H` makes a help file in the `help/` folder, with passwords and keys taken out. Read it first (it is plain text), then send it to the person helping you, or paste it into Gemini.

Keys: menu `H` **More:** guide 09, guide 05

Changes and updates

How do I update the computer?

Once a week, in a terminal:

```
sudo apt update && sudo apt upgrade -y
```

This also updates Docker and Caddy, because they came from their makers' Ubuntu sources. If Ubuntu asks for a restart, type `sudo reboot`; the garden starts again by itself.

More: guide 01 (Part E), guide 22 (sudo)

How do I update the garden's own programs?

The menu has no update button for them. Menu `1` repairs what is broken, but it skips everything that already works, so it does not fetch newer versions. By hand: back up first (menu `6`, then `1`), then in the garden folder type the line below, which downloads newer copies of the ready-made programs (the database, the wiki, the sign-in page). Then menu `2` starts the new copies.

```
docker compose pull --ignore-buildable
```

More: guide 02 (Docker commands)

How does the phone app update?

Each time it opens, the app asks your website whether there is a newer app (the file `site/apps/version.json`). If there is, it offers it, and Android asks you before installing. A newer app only appears there when you build one yourself.

More: guide 17

Moving or removing

How do I move the garden to a new computer?

Install the garden on the new computer (menu `1`). Copy your newest backup into its `backups/` folder, then menu `7` and pick it. Your keys and email password are not in the backup: add them again with menu `K` and menu `8`, then `3`. To go online from there: menu `M`, then `1`, and point the router at the new computer (guide 14).

More: guide 13 (Moving to a new computer), guide 14

Can I give folders and pages my own names?

Yes, with menu `M`, then `18`. Do not rename them by hand: the code and the database still use the old name, and the page would break. The menu renames the file or folder AND

every place that uses it, shows you everything first, and makes a backup. One thing to know: the guides keep showing the names the garden came with. `logs/renames.tsv` lists what is called what now (menu `M`, `18`, then `4`). Moving the whole garden folder to a bigger disk is in the same menu (`3`).

Keys: menu `M`, then `18` **More:** guide 26

How do I uninstall it?

Menu `M`, then `12`. Choice `1` removes the programs and keeps your garden (photos, database, backups); menu `1` installs it again. Choice `2` removes everything, but first makes a final backup and asks you to type `DELETE`.

More: guide 19 (Uninstall)

Windows and Docker

I already use Docker Desktop. Is that a problem?

No. When you install on this PC, the installer asks which Docker to use. Docker Desktop is the easy way: the garden's programs show in its window, with buttons. Docker inside Ubuntu is the hands-on way. If you picked the hands-on way, keep Docker Desktop's WSL integration switched off for `JunsGarden` (Docker Desktop > Settings > Resources > WSL integration); the checklist warns you if it is on. The clean-up never touches the images of your other Docker projects.

More: guide 26 (On Windows: two ways to run Docker)

I have an old Windows 7 PC. Can I use it?

Not for the garden. Windows 7 gets no security updates since January 2020, so it is not safe for a website on the internet, and it has no WSL and no current Docker. Put Ubuntu on that old laptop instead (copy your files to a USB stick first), or run the garden on another computer and use the old PC only to look at it.

More: guide 26, guide 01

Can someone else start their own garden with this?

Yes: the code is public and free to use (MIT license). Without your garden's data the installer sets up an empty garden. A starter garden for new people, with free-to-use plants for their area and their own photos, is an idea for a later version; it is not in this one.

More: guide 18 (the public code)

Next: 19 Every menu option, explained